

The Deputy Minister of Railways and Transport (Shri Alagesan): (a) No.

(b) Does not arise.

Drinking Water in Delhi

1200. Shri Kamath : Will the Minister of Health be pleased to state :

(a) whether the drinking water of Delhi is still over-chlorinated;

(b) if so, the reasons therefor; and

(c) when it will return to normalcy ?

The Minister of Health (Rajkumari Amrit Kaur) : (a) Yes; it is slightly over-chlorinated;

(b) Hundreds of labourers are working in water at the Intake works, just in front of the Intake wells, to remove silt from the river bed and as long as they have to work there, it is considered desirable to continue the excess dose of chlorine, which is not harmful.

(c) The excess dose will be discontinued as soon as the river settles down or when the use of manual labour at the wells is not required.

Medical Education

1201. Shri Kamath : Will the Minister of Health be pleased to state :

(a) whether Government propose to provide facilities for education in Ayurveda, Unani and Homoeopathic systems of medicine; and

(b) if so, the details of any Plan or Scheme in connection therewith ?

The Minister of Health (Rajkumari Amrit Kaur) : (a) Yes.

(b) Under the Second Five Year Plan a provision of Rs. 100 lakhs has been made in the Central Plan for the development of the Ayurvedic, Unani & Homoeopathic Systems of Medicine. Grants will be given through State Governments for the purpose of upgrading educational institutions in these Systems of Medicine.

The Government of India in association with the former State of Saurashtra have already established a Post-Graduate Training Centre in Ayurveda at Jamnagar in July 1956 to provide facilities for post-graduate training in Ayurveda. The Centre will have a full time staff of its own and a hospital with fifty beds which will be enlarged to contain 100 beds. 25 Students are proposed to be taken for training to start with and the training will be entirely along Ayurvedic lines.

The Government of India have sanctioned a sum of Rs. 38,020/- to the Government of Bombay for starting a Post-

graduate Training Centre in Homoeopathy at the Government Homoeopathic Hospital Sion, Bombay. Further, a grant of Rs. 1,49,890/- was sanctioned for upgrading the Calcutta Homoeopathic Medical college to the Degree Standard.

A provision of Rs. 5.5 crores has also been made in the Second Five Year Plans of States for the development of these systems of medicine. The schemes of State Governments are expected to include *inter alia* the expansion of existing colleges and the starting of five new Ayurvedic Colleges.

Railway Overbridge at Anantapur

1202. Shri Lakshmayya : Will the Minister of Railways be pleased to state :

(a) whether the Municipality of Anantapur, in Andhra has sent a resolution to Government that they would bear the costs of construction of an over-bridge or under-bridge as proposed at the level crossing of the railway line in the heart of the town and made representation to the Railway Board to construct the bridge, which is absolutely necessary to facilitate the people and the traffic to pass freely ;

(b) if so, whether Government propose to construct the said bridge; and

(c) whether Government propose to grant loan to the Municipality to meet its share of costs for the construction ?

The Deputy Minister of Railways and Transport (Shri Alagesan) : (a) Government have no such information.

(b) The railway level crossing at mile 42/11-12 near Anantapur Railway Station is included in the list of Level Crossings recommended by the Government of Andhra for replacement by overbridges and the work will be taken up in due course.

(c) Does not arise in view of reply to (a) above.

Level Crossing in Anantapur Town

1203. Shri Lakshmayya : Will the Minister of Railways be pleased to state :

(a) whether the Municipality of Anantapur (Andhra) has made a representation to put up a new level crossing at a place, one furlong away from the Railway Station towards north to facilitate the people to pass freely across the Railway lines between Garladinna and Anantapur and

(b) whether Government have taken into consideration the necessity of putting up this level to cross the lines ?

The Deputy Minister of Railways and Transport (Shri Alagesan) : (a) and (b). At the instance of the Anantapur Municipality, it was originally decided to provide a 12 ft. manned level crossing on the Northern side of Anantapur Railway Station. The Municipality agreed to bear the initial cost of the above proposal but declined to bear the annual maintenance charges thereof.

Meanwhile, the proposal had to be revised.

The Municipality had been advised to convey their acceptance of the revised charges in August '56 but their reply has not been received so far.

Sale of the "Current" at Railway Bookstalls

1204. Shri M. S. Gurupadaswamy: Will the Minister of Railways be pleased to state:

(a) whether it is a fact that the Public Relation Officer of South Eastern Railway recently issued instructions to Wheelers' Railway Bookstalls not to sell the 'Current', a Bombay Weekly News Magazine;

(b) if so, when and on what grounds;

(c) whether he subsequently revoked the said instructions; and

(d) if so, when and in what circumstances ?

The Deputy Minister of Railways and Transport (Shri Alagesan) : (a) and (c). Yes.

(b) and (d). The instructions under reference were issued by the Public Relations Officer on 6-9-56 due to misunderstanding, and these instructions were cancelled by him on 24-9-56 when the correct position was appreciated.

Railway Connection from Ichal-Karanji to Kolhapur-Miraj Line

1205. Shri Kajrolkar : Will the Minister of Railways be pleased to state:

(a) whether a representation has been received by Government from the Maharashtra Chamber of Commerce, Poona, requesting to connect Ichal-Karanji instead of Hathkanangale to the broad-gauge line to be laid between Kolhapur and Miraj on account of the industrial and commercial importance of Ichal-Karanji; and

(b) if the reply to part (a) be in the affirmative, what steps Government propose to take in the matter ?

The Deputy Minister of Railways and Transport (Shri Alagesan) :

(a) Yes.

(b) An estimate for Preliminary Engineering and Traffic Surveys for conversion of Kolhapur Miraj M.G. section into B.G. has been called for from the Central Railway. The question of connecting Ichal-Karanji instead of Hathkanangale has been noted for consideration during the survey.

Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes Officers on Railways

1206. Shri Kajrolkar : Will the Minister of Railways be pleased to lay a statement on the Table showing the number of officers belonging to Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes in Class I and Class II Services in the Railways at present ?

The Deputy Minister of Railways and Transport (Shri Alagesan) : A statement is laid on the Table of the House. [See Appendix V, annexure No. 72.]

Foodgrains

1208. Sardar Akarpuri : Will the Minister of Food and Agriculture be pleased to state :

(a) the normal offtake of foodgrains from Government stocks, State-wise during the last one year;

(b) whether there is any indication of anti-social activities by the traders in respect of the foodgrains sold by Government; and

(c) if so, whether there are any checks ?

The Deputy Minister of Food (Shri M. V. Krishnappa) : (a) A statement is placed on the table of Lok Sabha showing the quantities of foodgrains issued from Government stocks in each State during the period from 1st December, 1955 to 30th November, 1956. [See Appendix, V, annexure No. 73].

(b) and (c). Some reports about leakage of Government foodgrains from fair price shops have been received and the State Governments have been requested to keep strict watch on the functioning of these shops and arrange for their frequent inspection so as to ensure that foodgrains issued from Government stocks reach the consumers at prescribed prices.

Mail Trains to Bhopal

1209. Shri A. C. Joshi : Will the Minister of Railways be pleased to